

Day 2 — Working Backwards · Facilitator Guide

Companion to `labs/day-02-working-backwards.md`. Facilitator-only — do not hand to participants. Cues, answer keys, timings, reflections.

Activity 1 — Forward or Backward?

Answer key (vignette verdicts):

- **Vignette A** — Forward — tool-first. (Built the iOS rewrite before checking what techs actually used; missed the Android switch.)
- **Vignette B** — Backward — validated PR. (Mock press release circulated for reaction; re-scoped to the real blocker, login.)
- **Vignette C** — Backward by accident — or forward but lucky? Force the debate. The satisfaction bump doesn't tell you whether the outcome was designed for.
- **Vignette D** — Forward disguised as backward — the PR was fiction, not grounded fiction. AI-generated quotes with no persona research.

Cues:

- Protect Vignette D's discussion. The "fictional customer quote" is the most common PR/FAQ failure in practice — make sure the room names it.
- If a triad confidently classifies C as forward or backward, push back. The ambiguity is the lesson.

Activity 2 — Headline + Sub-headline

Cues:

- If a triad picks their favorite candidate without running the AI critique, push them back to step 3 — the critique is the muscle.
- The "interchangeable with a competitor's marketing" question kills the favored draft often. That's the lesson; let it sting.

Activity 3 — Answer the Five, Concretely

Cues:

- Walk the room watching for generic customers and benefit bouquets — the two most common failure modes.
- If a triad's customer quote uses marketing language, ask them to read it aloud in the dispatcher's voice. The mismatch becomes obvious.

Activity 4 — Cross-Triad PR/FAQ Review

Cues:

- Enforce "questions only" in the critique block. The first time someone breaks it, name it gently and reset.
- Triads that change nothing after critique usually didn't hear it. Walk over and ask what surprised them — that opens the door.